

AI is also changing the way the financial system works—from basic tools like ‘Splitwise’ that divides a sum of money equally between a group of friends, to AI-powered tools that analyse large amounts of financial data to detect fraud and predict market trends. AI is also used for customer service, where chatbots handle customer queries efficiently.

In automobiles, AI is widely used in the safety of the car, passengers and pedestrians through the advanced driver-assistance system. On the flip side, concerns about the potential for cyberattacks on cars in general and self-driving cars in particular abound.

In education, AI tools are helping teachers schedule classes and manage teaching patterns. “Being freed from repetitive and tedious work, the teacher can focus on adopting more meaningful curriculum, modes of teaching, and personalising teaching to suit the needs of each and every student,” says Nilima Chandiramani, Dean, NGLC, Mumbai University and Director at DM Harish School of Law.

30 | Start-ups, which are job creators, have turned to AI for onboarding of employees, and customer and employee service, cutting down on human intervention. Several other industries have either taken to AI in a big way (such as capital markets) or are mulling its possibilities (such as in consumer goods and retail). Read their stories in the ensuing pages.

EXPERTS FROM MULTIPLE sectors say AI can take away mundane, repetitive jobs currently done by humans. This has already created significant impact in the capital markets, for instance. Other industries such as manufacturing, transportation and finance could be equally affected in future. While new job opportunities would be created in areas such as data science and programming, the transition to a new job market may be difficult for workers who lose their jobs to AI-powered systems. Goldman Sachs says globally, about 300 million jobs could be lost or diminished due to generative AI. Fearing the impact of AI, someone like Devarsh Saraf, a law student at Columbia University, founded a legal-tech firm, ARBDossier, instead of looking for a job.

But there are optimistic voices as well. “During the dotcom boom, the world thought computers will make man go out of a job, but that didn’t happen, and

so it won’t happen this time, too,” Infosys Founder N.R. Narayana Murthy told *BT* on the sidelines of an event. Murthy further explained that a generative AI tool like ChatGPT provides the knowledge to a user who can then use it further as per their creativity. Agrees Krishnan Ramamujam, President, Enterprise Growth Business at Tata Consultancy Services: “AI and automation taking jobs is an old and boring story. Tech changes with every generation but it’s primarily driven by automation... There’s no threat of a job loss, but AI and automation will definitely compel employees to upskill to stay more relevant.”

A report by the World Economic Forum says technology and digitalisation will drive roles such as data analysts, data scientists, big data specialists, AI/ML specialists and cybersecurity professionals, who are expected to grow on average by 30 per cent by 2027. Tech industry body Nasscom predicts that over 290,000 jobs will be created this year in tech in India, of which 36 per cent will be generated in AI and ML. “AI will definitely make jobs easier and create a need to upskill, but it will only take over jobs that don’t require humans. New tech has always been a creator of jobs—earlier there were no Uber drivers, or Zomato/Swiggy delivery boys. These jobs were created because of technology,” says Debjani Ghosh, President of Nasscom.

And while AI can be useful, there are limitations and risks. “AI is great for research, but markets run on sentiment, not on algorithms,” says Nikhil Kamath, Co-

BY 2030, AI WILL LEAD TO AN ESTIMATED **\$15.7 TRILLION INCREASE** IN GLOBAL GDP, SAYS PwC’S GLOBAL ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE STUDY

founder of Zerodha. That’s a limitation. In terms of risks, AI-powered systems are only as good as the data they are trained on. So, good data, good AI. Bad or biased data, bad AI. For example, ChatGPT spewing out smart text is cool. But that the text may be incomplete, biased, or downright wrong is not so cool. Such scenarios are dangerous in sectors such as healthcare and law, where wrong decisions can have significant consequences for individuals.

And so, is AI more powerful than nukes? Maybe not today. And it’s best if it stays that way, through tight regulatory mechanisms. Only then can the economy, business and society benefit from this significant and impactful technological advancement, without causing a takeover of the world by sentient machines. **BT**

@r_dhanrajani